

When someone talks about Flash what is the first thing that comes to your mind? Our guess would be “moving images, animation, and Flashy Stuff”. If your thoughts hover in that area, you’re not wrong but you’re not completely right either. In reality, Flash has now grown from a mere animation tool that it was, into a platform. The word platform is being thrown about loosely these days, so we’ll come to that in a bit and explain what makes Flash a platform. But first, let’s take a step back and understand how Flash has evolved. “Initially when Flash started off as an animation tool, people looked at it simply as something that can help creating animations for the web – things like banners and ads. But there’s a huge interactive angle to it that made the adoption of Flash so rampant,” says Himanshu Mody, CEO Tekno Point Multimedia, one of the leading Flash Training institutes in the country. Speaking of adoption, a 2013 study pegged the software developer workforce in India at 2.75 million developers and projected a growth of 90 per cent by 2018. Though impressive by itself, the actual figures may go way above these projections.

Lay of the land

At the very broad level we can classify two distinct streams that these technologies allow you to pursue in terms of a career. There’s the creative side involving design, that’s now increasingly being termed as Digital Content Creation. “For a designer it’s always Photoshop first. Then we take our design, import it in Flash and bring it to life. Flash gives you the ability to bring motion into still images and that’s what attracted me. It gives your website/animation/movie a sleekness. That’s how I started out”, says Abhilash Krishnan, Creative Director, UFO Digital. You have story telling mediums like film, television, or even advertising who use it for storyboarding and advertising companies that use it for creating rich media interactive banners. In the current scenario the digital content designer is in the next stage of evolution. Such designers will eventually have capabilities to create content in Print, Web and Mobile as well. “In the future I don’t see companies hiring print, web and mobile designers separately,” said Himanshu. “These next generation designers will be able to service any of these segments”.

Then there’s the programming-heavy development side of these web technologies that entail everything from RIAs (Rich Internet Applications) and Web Development to Gaming, to eLearning and Enterprise Level applications. Gaming companies leverage it for casual as well as high end MMORPGs